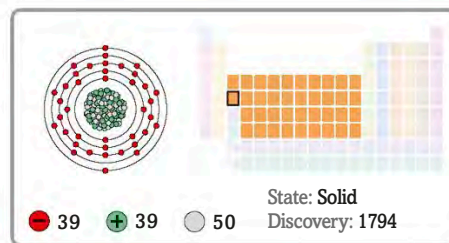


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Y

Yttrium



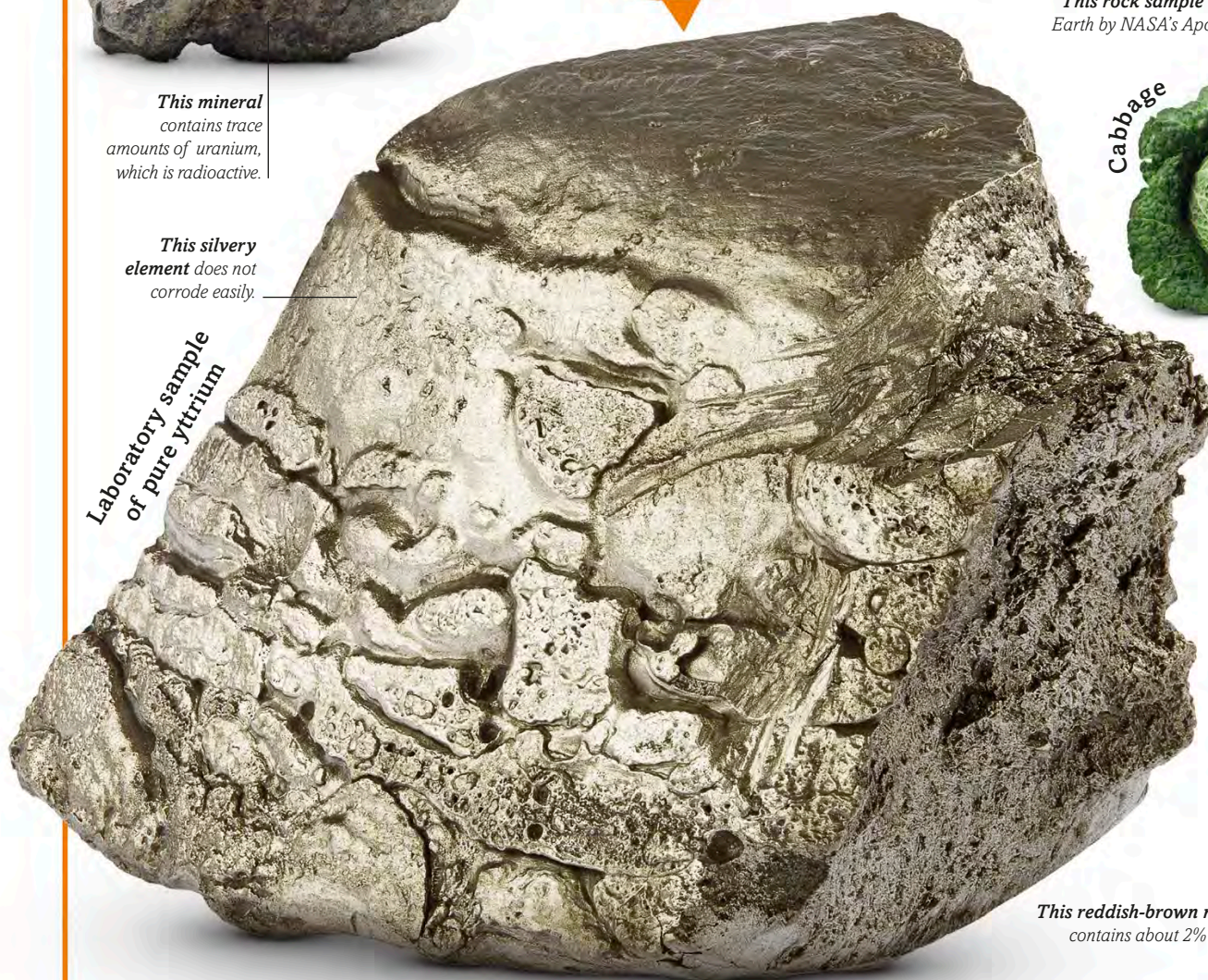
Forms



This mineral contains trace amounts of uranium, which is radioactive.

This silvery element does not corrode easily.

Laboratory sample of pure yttrium



Yttrium is **400 times more common** in Earth's crust than silver.

Moon rock



This rock sample was brought to Earth by NASA's Apollo 16 mission.

Cabbage



This vegetable contains yttrium.

Monazite



This reddish-brown mineral contains about 2% yttrium.

The samples of rock brought back from the Moon by astronauts in NASA's Apollo missions contained higher levels of yttrium than rocks on Earth. This element is never found in pure form in nature, but small traces of it are present in many minerals, including

xenotime and monazite. Yttrium was discovered in a compound in 1794 by the Finnish chemist Johan Gadolin, but it wasn't isolated until 1828. Other yttrium compounds have since been found in vegetables, including cabbage, and in seeds of woody plants. In